

Racism in high-tech corporations

Objectives:

- Introduce students to a story about IBM's first black software engineer
- Ask students to consider the windows and mirrors they see for themselves in this story
- Consider how workplace culture has effected database jobs historically
- Consider how workplace culture has changed over time

“My father was IBM’s first black software engineer. The racism he fought persists in the high-tech world today” By: Clyde W. Ford –

Step 1) Learn about John Stanley Ford’s career story through choosing one of the following options:

- A. Watch this video [1 hour, 23 minutes]: <https://www.c-span.org/video/?465027-1/think-black>

OR

- B. Read this article [10 minute read]: <https://www.latimes.com/opinion/story/2019-09-20/ibm-nazi-germany-tech-racism-father>

Step 2) Reflect on the following questions and write-down your answers:

- A. What windows do you see for yourself in John Stanley Ford’s experiences?
- B. What mirrors do you see for yourself in John Stanley Ford’s experiences?
- C. IBM is historically known for its database technology. Do you think the workplace culture that Mr. Ford experienced had an impact on how the database technology was designed? Why or why not?

Step 3) Submit the written answers as described by your instructor.
(This is typically done in Blackboard)